

LIBERTY CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE

THE ALAMO THREAT BRIEF™

OPEN SOURCE INTELLIGENCE

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Executive decision intelligence for Texas critical infrastructure.

Liberty CTI

The Alamo Threat Brief™

Weekly cyber threat intelligence for Texas industry — designed for fast executive consumption with short, source-backed assessments.

Issue:

ATB-2026-1

Week of:

16 March 2026

Coverage:

Energy · Finance · Healthcare · Defense · Gov · Tech

Elevated — Iran-linked retaliation activity ongoing across all sectors

This Week's Threats — 10–16 March 2026

ENERGY

Qilin ransomware targets Texas electric cooperatives; ERCOT grid probing persists

Summary: The Qilin ransomware gang — with confirmed Russian ties — claimed attacks on San Bernard and Karnes Electric cooperatives, leaking financial records and board-director PII. Incident follows sustained probing of Texas LNG export infrastructure.

Assessment: Qilin will almost certainly leverage exfiltrated director PII for targeted spearphishing against adjacent co-ops and upstream LNG operators. The gang's pattern — publish, then pivot — suggests a follow-on intrusion attempt against a larger Texas grid asset within 30–60 days, likely using stolen credentials from the initial breach as the entry vector.

[Source: Cybernews – Texas Electric Coop Ransomware](#)

FINANCE

NY DFS warns financial sector of heightened Iranian cyber threats amid U.S.-Iran

conflict

Summary: NY DFS issued an emergency advisory on 3 March tied to ongoing U.S.-Israel operations against Iran. Iran-aligned Hydro Kitten has signaled intent to target U.S. financial infrastructure. AI-driven phishing against finance teams is accelerating.

Assessment: Hydro Kitten will likely shift from reconnaissance to disruptive DDoS against U.S. financial platforms as Iran seeks visible retaliation options short of kinetic escalation. Texas-based payment processors and regional banks are probable secondary targets — large enough to generate political signal, small enough to lack enterprise-grade DDoS mitigation.

[Source: NY DFS – Cybersecurity Advisory 3 Mar 2026](#)

HEALTHCARE

Iran-linked Handala claims Stryker cyberattack; Senate advances healthcare cyber bill

Summary: Iran-affiliated hackers disrupted Stryker's global Microsoft environment — the first major U.S. healthcare supply-chain strike since U.S.-Iran hostilities escalated. Senate advanced bipartisan legislation requiring MFA, encryption, and HHS incident-response frameworks.

Assessment: Handala will likely expand beyond Stryker to other U.S. medical device and pharma manufacturers to sustain political pressure during the conflict. The group has demonstrated a preference for targets with high public visibility and downstream hospital dependencies — expect additional supply-chain disruptions timed to U.S. military operational tempo against Iran.

[Source: Chief Healthcare Executive – Stryker Attack](#)

DEFENSE

Salt Typhoon telecom espionage continues; Texas orders review of Chinese-made medical devices

Summary: China's Salt Typhoon APT has compromised 200+ firms across 80 countries, focusing on wiretap systems and defense-adjacent communications. Texas ordered a cybersecurity review of state agencies' Chinese-manufactured medical devices after federal warnings.

Assessment: Salt Typhoon will almost certainly use its persistent telecom access to map the communications patterns of Texas-based defense contractors and cleared personnel — building a targeting package for future collection rather than immediate disruption. The Chinese-device review is likely to surface undisclosed access points; MSS will move to deactivate or obfuscate implants before formal remediation orders are issued.

[Source: Industrial Cyber – TX Device Review & Salt Typhoon](#)

GOVERNMENT

FBI flags impersonation campaign targeting permit applicants; Texas municipalities remain exposed

Summary: FBI warned of a U.S.-wide phishing campaign impersonating local officials to steal permit

payments via publicly available zoning data. Texas cities including McKinney, Coppell, and Richardson disclosed attacks over the past year.

Assessment: The impersonation operators behind this campaign will almost certainly expand their target set from permit applicants to utility payment portals and tax collection systems — higher-value transactions with the same OSINT-rich zoning and property records as a data source. Ransomware actors monitoring the Mission, TX incident will likely probe other border-region municipalities, anticipating that crisis-mode governments pay faster.

[Source: Digital Forensics Magazine – 13 Mar 2026 Roundup](#)

TECHNOLOGY

AI-generated "Slopoly" malware enables Interlock ransomware dwell; White House demands active defense

Summary: AI-generated malware "Slopoly" gave Interlock ransomware operators undetected access for over a week before exfiltration. The White House's 6-pillar National Cybersecurity Strategy (6 March) formally calls on the private sector to actively hunt and disrupt adversary networks.

Assessment: Interlock will use the Slopoly dwell-time advantage to replicate this playbook against additional managed service providers — AI-generated malware lowers their tooling cost while extending pre-exfiltration access windows. As the White House strategy increases private-sector threat-hunting pressure, Interlock and similar groups will likely accelerate their intrusion-to-extortion timelines to outpace newly mandated detection capabilities.

[Source: Digital Forensics Magazine – Slopoly / Interlock](#)

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